ISyE 6644 Project Rubric & Requirements – Spring 2026

(Revised 2/3/26)

The course project is worth 10% of your semester grade. The project will be graded out of 100 points.

Milestone 1: Project Topic & Team Selection (5 points)

You must complete all steps in this assignment to receive credit for your project report. Failure to follow the instructions listed here may result in deduction of points from your project report. You must select a topic that matches the number of members in your group. The ONLY exception to this is if you want to do a project that is listed for more members than you have (e.g., you are 2 people and want to do a project meant for 3 or 4 people; THERE ARE NO EXCEPTIONS TO THIS). **Everyone needs to complete this assignment.**

Question 1: Select your project topic from a list of all available topics.
Question 2: List all team member names here. If you are a solo group, just type your name.
Question 3: Provides instructions on how to create your group in Canvas. **(Every member of the team must complete this step even if you are a single person group.)**

Milestone 2: Project Progress Report (5 points)

All we are looking for here are a couple of paragraphs describing what you have done so far and what you still need to do. **Only one team member needs to turn in this assignment, but you must clearly and unambiguously list EVERYONE on the team**. Failure to do so will result in loss of points. The intent is not to provide an almost completed report as the TAs will not be grading anything beyond checking to see that you have provided the paragraphs. Please do not submit a rough draft copy of your project. **Also include the specific Project Topic number you have selected.**

Milestone 3: Final Report (90 points)

Please submit 2 files as a part of submission (if you chose a non-coding-based topic then you only need to provide your report).

One file will be a pdf file, which will cover your final project report. The PDF must be separate from the zip file.

The second file should be a zip file, which will cover all the code documents, Arena file, and any other file you may think important to submit. We do not need every single individual file that you have ever created while working on your project nor do we need the entire version control history of any source code. Please include a README file in the zip folder, explaining what each file is, so that we can evaluate your projects easily. If your download is failing to Canvas, then that means the file is too large and you have included files that are not required to adequately assess your project. You cannot submit links to Google Docs, GitHub, or any other online link to the content of your project.

For each group, only one person from that group needs to submit the project files.

Project Administration Duties (10 Points)

Task	Due Date	Points
Project Topic & Team Selection	**Friday, February 20th 11:59 PM Atlanta Time**	5
Progress Report (just a couple of paragraphs)	**Friday, March 13th 11:59 PM Atlanta Time**	5

Project Content (90 Points)

Due Date: Tuesday, April 28th 11:59 PM Atlanta Time

Plan Ahead. Do not try submitting it to Canvas at 11:58 PM Atlanta Time!

Task	Points	Description
Title & Group Member Names	5	Include a descriptive title, the project topic number, the group number, and all group member names (even if you picked a solo topic) at the beginning of your project.
Abstract	5	A short synopsis (at most 200 words) of what problem you are working on, including major findings.
Background & Description of the Problem	5	Some details of the problem under investigation (e.g., a literature review along with a description of the organization of what is coming up in the remainder of the write-up).
Main Findings	50	The main findings of a project will clearly depend on what type of project you are doing, how many people are in the group, etc. Below are some guidelines related to the broad categories from the original project list document. **It is important to note that these items are not a checklist or a set of requirements that you must fulfill to complete your project. Instead, they serve as general guidelines to help you think about aspects of your project. Additionally, you are expected to incorporate relevant concepts and topics covered in the course that apply to simulation.** Applications-Oriented "Real-World" Problems. • Describe in detail the applications area (e.g., all the potential ways that you can play with an inventory policy, why it is important, etc.). • Collect some data from someplace – e.g., an actual company, get it yourself, find it online, or (in an emergency) make it up, but with justification. • Do an elementary data analysis and maybe some curve fitting, if appropriate. • Simulate your model (e.g., in Arena), hopefully using the data analysis you undertook. • Analyze the output, make improvements/conclusions. Language- and Modeling-Oriented Problems. • Explain how the language works (at least at a basic level). • Provide a tutorial / user guide with your own examples (please do not use the examples found in the online documentation). • Outline good points and not-so-good points. • Make a very quick comparison with Arena. Programming-Oriented Problems. • Describe the problem at hand thoroughly and past efforts by others to solve it. • Develop and document your code. • Show how to run your program(s). • Give illustrations of what you can learn from your code (e.g., whether a PRN generator is any good, or whether a certain strategy will work better than others in blackjack). Make sure to be statistically rigorous (e.g., estimates, confidence intervals, hypothesis tests, etc.) if you are carrying out Monte Carlo experiments. Theory-Oriented Problems • Describe the problem at hand thoroughly and past efforts by others to solve it. • What are the techniques used to derive the main findings? • Describe some of the fundamental results (e.g., this paper gives an explicit expression for an estimator's expected value in terms of the covariance function). • Formulate (but you do not have to solve) a couple of research problems that might be derived from this work.

Task	Points	Description
Conclusions	5	What did you find/learn from the project? Provide ideas for future work that could be built using your project as a starting point.
Presentation, Writing Quality, and References/Citations (if appropriate)	20	Is the paper written clearly, succinctly, and professionally? Is it free of typPogrficLe errors? **All outside sources, including ChatGPT (and similar applications), used in the creation of your project need to be included and precisely described. Any direct quotes you use in your project must be clearly cited. It is not acceptable to copy and paste substantial portions of your project even if you cite it correctly. You can use any style of citations you want (APA, MLA, etc.). If you are not sure whether you should cite something, then cite it.**

And, finally, here are some hints/expectations about exposition:

- The idea is to have fun and learn something about a topic that interests you.
- Then convey that interest to your readers. Write in a style that is clear, interesting, and well-thought-out; get a friend or two to proofread – no typos allowed in 6644! 😊
- While we suggest limiting your report to about 5 pages per person, this is not a strict requirement. The goal is to manage scope and prevent the inclusion of irrelevant details. Adding excessive content or writing many pages often detracts from the clarity and impact of your findings. Aim for concise, meaningful insights rather than overwhelming the reader with unnecessary information. There is no need for tedious lists of data/tables or excessive code unless that is central to your report's objectives. If you have additional relevant material, you can include this information in the zip file or as appendices to support your main report.
- I am guessing you can bat this off in <15 hours of work per group member (just a guideline).
- Copying code you have found online in whole, or part is not in the spirit of academic integrity. If you absolutely must utilize a piece of code you have sourced online, please be sure to cite it. Copying sections of code and changing variable names and claiming it as your own is not permitted.
- If you use ChatGPT, fully document precisely what you did!
- **NO PLAGIARISM** – we have seen EVERYTHING, and we will catch you! ☹️